

ACHIEVE!

HISTORY



World War I

Book 2

Kate Crowhurst



**Made for the
Australian Curriculum**



Achieve! History

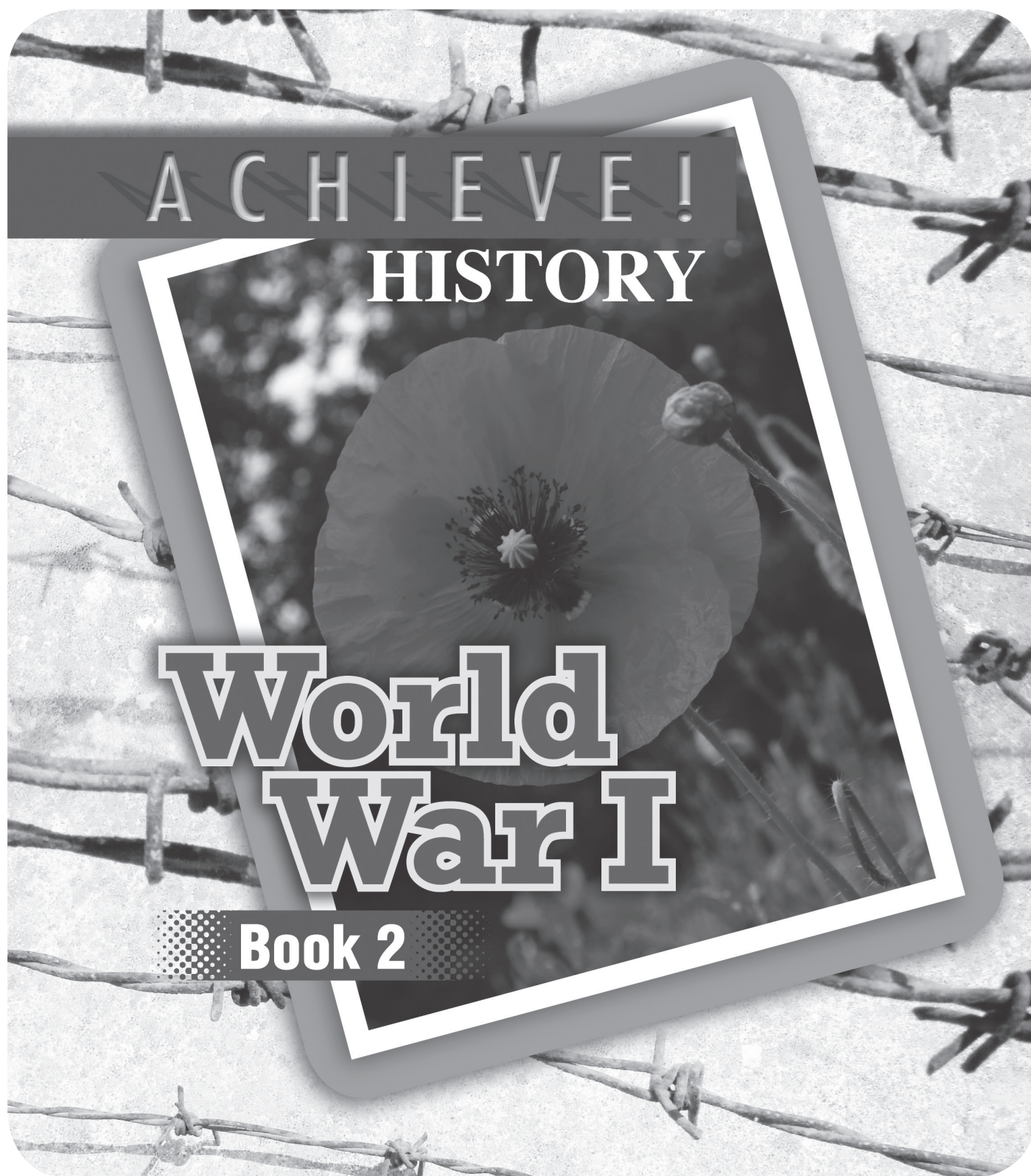
World War I – Book 2

Features

- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills.
- ✓ Comprehensive Teacher's Notes, providing clear objectives, background information, starter and extension activities.
- ✓ A CD-ROM containing all the pages from the book that can be used on the Interactive Whiteboard, along with Word documents of all work sheets that can be edited to suit the individual needs of students and selected illustrations that can be added to new teacher-created work sheets.
- ✓ Aligned to the Australian Curriculum. See guide below.

The Australian Curriculum alignment Year 9	Unit									
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
The places where Australians fought and the nature of warfare during World War I, including the Gallipoli campaign (ACDSEH095)	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓				
The impact of World War I, with a particular emphasis on Australia (such as the use of propaganda to influence the civilian population, the changing role of women, the conscription debate) (ACDSEH096)					✓				✓	
The commemoration of World War I, including debates about the nature and significance of the Anzac legend (ACDSEH097)		✓								✓
Use historical terms and concepts (ACHHS165)		✓			✓	✓				
Identify and select different kinds of questions about the past to inform historical inquiry (ACHHS166)					✓				✓	
Evaluate and enhance these questions (ACHHS167)									✓	
Process and synthesise information from a range of sources for use as evidence in an historical argument (ACHHS170)								✓		✓
Evaluate the reliability and usefulness of primary and secondary sources (ACHHS171)								✓	✓	
Identify and analyse the perspectives of people from the past (ACHHS172)	✓		✓	✓		✓	✓	✓		
Identify and analyse different historical interpretations (including their own) (ACHHS173)	✓						✓			
Select and use a range of communication forms (oral, graphic, written) and digital technologies (ACHHS175)			✓			✓				✓





Kate Crowhurst

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Kate Crowhurst is a young and energetic educator with experience across diverse education sectors. A finalist for the United Nations Youth Australia Representative in 2013, she has a passion for making connections between prior knowledge and history.

Kate’s education mission is to ensure that language is no barrier to learning and engaging with history. Kate’s approach is enhanced by her qualifications and experience in teaching history in tandem with literacy and English as a Second Language. Kate has conducted several workshops for history teachers in Victoria, making history accessible and engaging to all students.

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The *Achieve!* series of History titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

World War I – Book 2 looks at Australia's role at Gallipoli and the Western Front, the nature of warfare, strategies for maintaining morale, the role of nurses and the role of America in ending the war. The consequences of the war are also studied, such as the loss of life, how returning soldiers adjusted to civilian life, the Treaty of Versailles and the emergence of America as a new world power. Historical and literacy skills are developed through interpreting photographs, journals, poetry and songs from the era. Students develop skills in generating historical questions and communicating in different forms.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of selected illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, containing photocopiable Resource sheets and Activity sheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single Resource sheet and related Activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements.

Objectives – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the work sheets.

Prior knowledge – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others, however, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.

Background – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers to present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.

Starter activity – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.

Resource and Activity work sheets – The Resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The Activity sheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the students.

Extension ideas – Additional tasks are suggested to recap the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, or to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.



Objectives

- To identify where Australians fought
- To understand the type of warfare used at Gallipoli
- To understand different perspectives
- To understand different historical interpretations

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

The Anzac legend was born out of the tough conditions that Australian and New Zealand troops fought under at Gallipoli in Turkey. More than 20 000 Anzacs landed on the beaches of Gallipoli at dawn on 25 April 1915. While Australians went on to fight campaigns on the Western Front and in the Middle East, it was at Gallipoli that the Anzacs established their military identity.

Those recruited into the Australian Imperial Force were sent to Egypt to stop the threat of Turkey (formerly the Ottoman Empire) to the British in the Middle East. Australians were deployed to the Gallipoli Peninsula in April 1915 with the goal of taking over the Turkish capital, Constantinople. They were accompanied by troops from New Zealand, France and Britain.

After the Australians landed at what is now referred to as Anzac Cove, there was fierce fighting between Australian and Turkish troops. Most attempts to gain territory ended in failure for both sides, and this stalemate continued throughout 1915. When the Australians retreated on 19–20 December they had achieved the most effective campaign of Gallipoli, as the Turkish troops did minimal damage to the Anzac troops compared to the losses they inflicted during earlier battles.

Starter activity

Begin by showing the class images of Anzac Day celebrations in Australia and Turkey. Ask students to identify the locations of the Anzac Day services and to consider why the service takes place at dawn on this day each year.

Before beginning the unit, hold a class discussion about the importance of perspective – how does being on a particular side effect how you see events? Allow students to explore the concept of bias in their own lives and how this can affect their judgement and choices.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Australian perspectives at Gallipoli (1)', gives students the background to the Gallipoli campaign and presents an Australian's perspective on the campaign.

In the Activity sheet, 'Australian perspectives at Gallipoli (2)', students answer questions to help them analyse sources in order to gain an understanding of Australian perspectives.

The Resource sheet, 'Turkish perspectives at Gallipoli (1)', offers students an alternative interpretation by identifying the Turkish perspective of the Gallipoli campaign.

The Activity sheet, 'Turkish perspectives at Gallipoli (2)', encourages students to consider the Turkish perspective by answering questions about the sources.

The final Activity sheet, 'Bias and historical interpretation', provides students with the ability to identify bias in historical interpretations.

Extension ideas

- Students could view the 1981 Australian film *Gallipoli*, directed by Peter Weir, and create character profiles of the soldiers presented in the film in order to gain a deeper understanding of the perspectives of Anzacs who fought at Gallipoli.
- Note: It would be worth pointing out inaccuracies in the film, such as the little British command at the Nek, to students so that they are aware of the differences between cinema and historical record.
- Students could research the number of casualties/deaths sustained by other nations at Gallipoli, such as India, New Zealand, Great Britain and Germany.

Australian perspectives at Gallipoli (1)

Anzac stands for the **A**ustralian and **N**ew **Z**ealand **A**rmy **C**orps. All the men in the Anzacs had volunteered to fight in World War I, and many were leaving Australia for the first time. At first it must have seemed like an adventure, a free trip around the world, but the troops were soon faced with the harsh realities of war.

In April 1915 the Anzacs were **deployed** to the Gallipoli Peninsula with the goal of taking over the then Turkish capital, Constantinople. As soon as the Australians landed at Anzac Cove, fierce fighting broke out between Australian and Turkish troops. Most attempts to gain territory ended in failure for both sides. This **stalemate** continued throughout 1915.

Source 1



This photo was taken at Gallipoli, Turkey, 22 May 1915. It shows Australian soldiers from the 4th Battalion having their breakfast. Photographer unknown. Courtesy, Australian War Memorial H15685.

Source 2

This was written by Australian soldier Arthur Taylor. He is describing a night in Gallipoli in a letter to home.

A pitch dark night and you standing in a narrow trench just wide enough to stop your shoulders from rubbing the sides, you can only see a handsbreadth in front of your face you hear the hiss of bullets passing overhead you cannot strike a match as the flare might cost one of your mates his life you move silently along pass the Officer on Duty he is muffled up to the eyes for the cold is bitter you look on one platform and there is the machine gun stripped of his outer casing ready to deal out death to any Turks that try to rush our trench we were only 40 yards apart.

– **Arthur Taylor**

Source: Taylor, A H Manuscript held at the State Library of Victoria MS 12286

Australian perspectives at Gallipoli (2)

The Australians fighting at Gallipoli were the first Anzacs to fight on the battlefield during World War I. It is important to understand their perspectives on the war while they were fighting at Gallipoli. To do this we look at pieces of evidence, or primary sources, that show Anzac perspectives from the time of the fighting.

 Read the Resource sheet, ‘Australian perspectives at Gallipoli (1)’, then complete the following table.

	Source 1	Source 2
1 Does it show the Turkish or Australian perspective?		
2 What is the source type? (e.g. letter, photo, etc.)		
3 Who created the source?		
4 Is the source from before, during or after the Gallipoli campaign (25 April 1915 to 9 January 1916)?		
5 What is happening in the source? <i>What is it describing?</i>		
6 Who is the audience? <i>Who was it made for?</i>		His parents, friends and family in Australia
7 What is the purpose of the source? <i>Why was it written?</i> (e.g. to persuade, to explain, to report, etc.)		

Turkish perspectives at Gallipoli (1)

It is important to always look at both sides of an argument. The Turkish troops were defending their home against the Anzac forces. Below are some primary sources from the time of the Gallipoli campaign, reflecting the Turkish experience and perspective on their battle against the Anzacs at Gallipoli.

Source 3

This photograph shows Colonel Mustafa Kemal (fourth from left) with officers and staff from the Turkish army. This was taken on the Gallipoli Peninsula in 1915. Kemal later became the first president of Turkey, when Turkey became a republic in 1923.



Courtesy, Australian War Memorial P01141.001.

Source 4

The text below is part of a tribute that Kemal wrote to the Anzacs who were killed at Gallipoli. He wrote it in 1934, the same year that he accepted the title 'Atatürk', which means 'father of the Turks'. The changes Kemal initiated (made) during his 15 years as ruler made Turkey as modern as other countries, making him a hero to his people.

In 1933, Kemal said, 'I look to the world with an open heart full of pure feelings and friendship.' The writing below can be found at the Kemal Atatürk Memorial on Anzac Parade in Canberra.

*Those heroes that shed their blood and lost their lives... You are now lying in the soil of a friendly country. Therefore rest in peace. There is no difference between the **Johnnies** and the **Mehmets** to us where they lie side by side now here in this country of ours ... you, the mothers, who sent their sons from faraway countries wipe away your tears; your sons are now lying in our bosom and are in peace. After having lost their lives on this land. They have become our sons as well.*

Note:

Johnnies – John and Johnny were common Australian names

Mehmets – Mehmet was a common Turkish name

Turkish perspectives at Gallipoli (2)

The two sources on the previous page look at the Turkish side of the fighting at Gallipoli. We need to ask questions about the sources in order to understand what these sources can tell us about history.

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Turkish perspectives at Gallipoli (1)'; then complete the following table.

	Source 3	Source 4
1 Does it show the Turkish or Australian perspective?		
2 What is the source type? (e.g. letter, photo, etc.)		A written tribute
3 Who created the source?		
4 Is the source from before, during or after the Gallipoli campaign (25 April 1915 to 9 January 1916)?		After the Gallipoli campaign (by someone who was there during the campaign)
5 What is happening in the source? <i>What is it describing?</i>		
6 Who is the audience? <i>Who was it made for?</i>		
7 What is the purpose of the source? <i>Why was it written?</i> (e.g. to persuade, to explain, to report, etc.)	To show what soldiers on the frontline looked like	

Bias and historical interpretation

History is the study of people and events from the past. When studying history, it is important to be aware of **bias**. This means being more likely to favour a particular point of view. Everyone has a favourite football team, TV show, type of music, etc. These preferences can affect, or bias, the way we judge other things. We need to recognise bias when looking at historical sources in order to form a balanced opinion.

Bias and sources

-  1
- Read the Resource sheets, 'Australian perspectives at Gallipoli (1)' and 'Turkish perspectives at Gallipoli (1)', then complete the table below to identify the bias that might exist in the sources shown.

	Source 1	Source 2	Source 3	Source 4
Which side did the creator fight for?	Australian side			
Who did they make the source for?		His parents (Australian side)		
Is the creator biased?			Yes	
What words or parts of the picture make you think this?			He is taking a posed photo of the Turkish side	
What is the creator trying to make the reader think?				That both sides lost men at Gallipoli and are now at peace
Do you agree or disagree with the opinion of the source?				

Objectives

- To identify where Australia fought
- To understand the Anzac legend
- To be able to use key terms and concepts
- To understand historical questions

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

In March 1916, after the Gallipoli campaign, the Anzacs were sent to France, having proven their abilities in battle. They served on the Western Front, where Germany had invaded Luxembourg, Belgium and France until their advance was stopped by Triple Entente forces. Both sides reached a line that remained largely unchanged for most of the war – indeed, from 1916 to 1917, the warring sides advanced only metres at a time. It was only when America joined the war in 1917, fighting with the Triple Entente, that there was any major change. The victorious Triple Entente pushed for Germany's surrender on 11 November 1918.

For Australia, this victory came at a particularly high cost. Australia's casualty rate was almost 65% – the highest in the British Empire. Of the 60 000 Australians (nearly all men) who died fighting in World War I, 45 000 were killed on the Western Front.

Starter activity

Show students a map of the Western Front. Ask them how they would feel if they were fighting a war but were unable to move forward and gain territory. Would they feel like continuing, or would they feel frustrated and unfulfilled?

Resource and Activity sheets

In the Activity sheet, 'The Western Front', students complete a cloze activity describing the location of the Western Front and explaining the purpose of the line there.

The Resource sheet, 'The Anzac spirit (1)', discusses the role of the Anzacs on the Western Front and the qualities that the Australian soldiers showed in battle.

The Activity sheet, 'The Anzac spirit (2)', introduces vocabulary used to describe the Anzacs. Students find synonyms and draw pictures to show their understanding. They then use these synonyms in a sentence describing the Anzacs.

The Resource sheet, 'Asking questions (1)', shows students how the terms used in questions indicate the required response. Students learn to identify what a question is asking them to show in their responses.

In the Activity sheet, 'Asking questions (2)', students apply the vocabulary modelled on the Resource sheet, phrasing essay questions about the qualities of the Anzacs. They then answer the questions they have constructed.

Extension ideas

- Students could choose one of the essay questions they responded to in the 'Asking questions' Resource and Activity sheets and expand their response into a longer essay or a class presentation. They could also undertake a second response to show how changing the language term used in the question will change their response.
- Students could access film texts such as *Blackadder Goes Fourth*, to help them identify the mentality of the men in the trenches and the futility of the battles on the Western Front.

The Western Front

 Use the word bank to complete the information below.

The Australian Imperial Force had proven themselves in battle at Gallipoli. Their ability to keep _____ through tough conditions showed that the Australians were capable, experienced soldiers. The **veterans** of this _____ became known as the Anzacs, or _____.

After Gallipoli, in _____ 1916, the Australian forces were sent to France to _____ at the **Western Front**. Germany had invaded Luxembourg, Belgium and France, and the _____ had stopped their advance. The _____ was the area of land where the two sides faced off in battle. Both sides reached a line that _____ unchanged for most of the war.

The Western Front is so-named because it was in _____ Europe. The _____ refers to the frontline, or the furthest the army has reached in its fight to gain _____. Germany and _____ were fighting battles on both sides of Europe – the British and French on the Western side and the Russians in the _____. Calling it the Western Front helps differentiate between these two battles.

Word bank

Western

fighting

Triple Entente

remained

East

territory

March

diggers

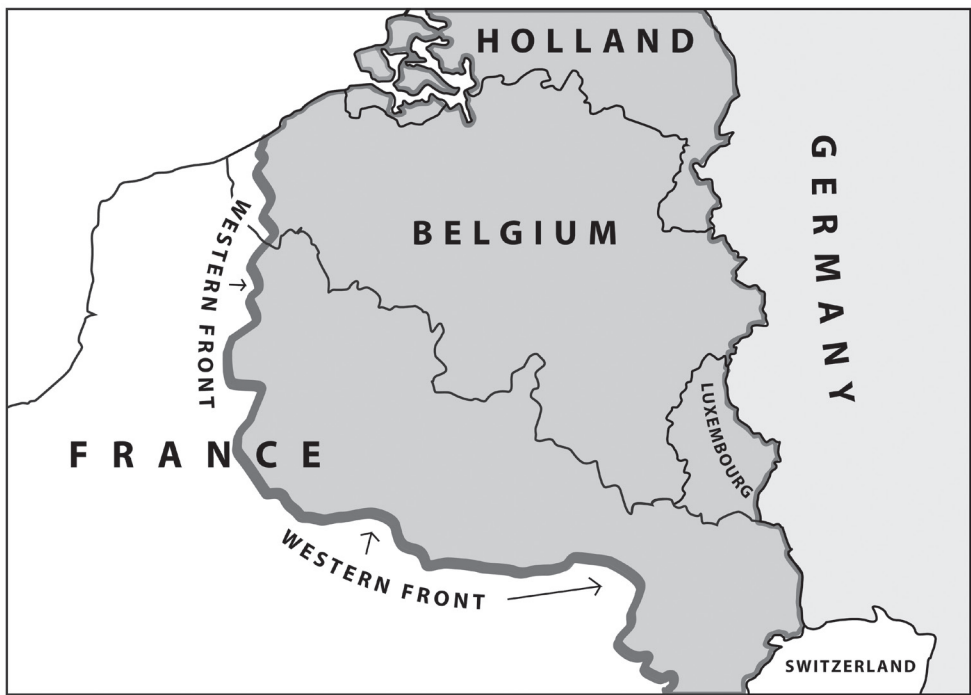
Austria-Hungary

front

fight

battle

Western Front



The Western Front stretched 750 km through Belgium and France, running from the Belgian coast to the Swiss–French border. The Australian troops took over a 16-km stretch of land in Northern France, where the experienced Gallipoli veterans were joined by new Australian recruits.

The Anzac spirit (1)

The Anzacs had a difficult time on the Western Front. They were fighting in tough conditions, and neither side was winning or gaining any ground.

The horrors of Gallipoli were repeated on an even larger scale at the Western Front. In their first battle with the Germans, 5533 Anzacs were killed or wounded. This was twice as many casualties as the Anzacs sustained at Gallipoli.

Australia lost almost 65% of its men at the Western Front. This was the highest death rate of the British Empire. Of the 60 000 Anzacs killed in World War I, 45 000 were killed at the Western Front. A further 124 000 were wounded, and many carried the scars of the Western Front for the rest of their lives, suffering from health problems and disabilities.

It was under these tough conditions, surrounded by allied forces, that the Anzacs demonstrated their true spirit to the rest of the world. Australian soldiers showed what it meant to be Australian. The diggers were known for their endurance, courage, good humour, larrikinism and mateship. In contrast to the British soldiers, the Anzacs became known for being **irreverent** (standing up to authority) and **egalitarian** (treating everyone equally, regardless of their rank or background).



This photo shows Australian soldiers walking along a duckboard track in the Chateau Wood, part of the Western Front. Photograph taken 29 October 1917. Courtesy, Australian War Memorial E01220.

The Anzac spirit (2)

 Read the Resource sheet, 'The Anzac spirit (1)', then answer the questions below.

1 The table below lists some of the vocabulary (words) that can be used to describe the Anzacs. Find three synonyms (words with a similar meaning) for each word, then draw a picture of what the word means to you. The first one has been done for you.

Qualities of the Anzacs	Picture	Qualities of the Anzacs	Picture
Endurance Three synonyms for endurance are: • patience • survival • stamina		Mateship Three synonyms for mateship are: • • •	
Courage Three synonyms for courage are: • • •		Irreverent Three synonyms for irreverent are: • • •	
Humour Three synonyms for humour are: • • •		Egalitarian Three synonyms for egalitarian are: • • •	

2 Look at the photo on the Resource sheet. Select three key words from the table above which you think are shown in the illustration. Use them in a sentence to describe the Anzacs.

Asking questions (1)

The way a question is asked tells us what kind of answer is required. A question might be asking you to remember, understand, apply, analyse, evaluate or create information.

Can you ... ?	Words that tell you what the question is asking you to do	Question starters ...	Example questions
Remember	describe name list	• What happened after ... ? • Describe what happened at ...	Describe the Western Front.
Understand	explain predict compare	• Who do you think ... ? • What differences exist between ... ?	Explain how the Western Front got its name.
Apply	use illustrate show	• What would you change if ... ? • What questions would you ask about ... ?	Illustrate the battlefield at the Western Front.
Analyse	identify compare explain	• Which events could have happened if ... ? • How was this similar to ... ?	Compare the battlefield of the Western Front with that of Gallipoli.
Evaluate	choose assess justify	• Which option would be best for ... ? • Explain why you chose this option.	Assess which was tougher – the Western Front or Gallipoli.
Create	create plan construct	• Can you see a possible solution to ... ? • What would happen if ... ?	Plan and create an essay arguing whether the Western Front or Gallipoli was the tougher battlefield.

Asking questions (2)

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Asking questions (1)'. You now need to apply the question constructions shown on the Resource sheet. For each kind of question, create an example relating to the qualities of the Anzacs, then come up with a response.

Can you...?	Words that tell you what the question is asking you to do	Example questions about the qualities of the Anzacs	Response
Remember	describe name list	Describe the qualities of the Anzacs.	
Understand	explain predict compare		
Apply	use illustrate show		
Analyse	identify compare explain		
Evaluate	choose assess justify		
Create	create plan construct		

Objectives

- To be able to describe the types of warfare during World War I
- To be able to use different forms of communication
- To understand different perspectives

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

With World War I came the emergence of trench warfare as the standard method of fighting. Trench warfare signalled a stalemate in a conflict, but for the soldiers, life in the trenches was hell on Earth. Soldiers faced certain death if they went 'over the top' of the parapet, running directly into machine-gun fire from the enemy trenches. Even when staying in their own trench, they were constantly under attack from enemy shells or snipers. If they managed to survive this they had to contend with the rats, lice and mud that infested the trenches and caused diseases such as trench fever, trench nephritis and trench foot. The freezing winter on the Western Front took the lives of many men. This significant loss of manpower meant that it was left to nurses and the use of new technology to support the remaining soldiers on the frontline.

Starter activity

Show students an image of the trenches. Ask them to describe the environment in which the soldiers fought and lived, using the following questions to guide the discussion:

- What is the environment like?
- What would it feel like to live there?
- How would this affect your motivation to fight?

Examples of image sources:

- www.bbc.co.uk/history/worldwars/wwone/launch_vt_trench_life.shtml
- www.abc.net.au/news/2012-04-20/anzacs-in-the-front-line-trenches-during-wwi/3963124

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource Sheet, 'Life in the trenches', helps students understand the nature of trench warfare, the environment in the trenches and the implications this had for the health of the soldiers.

The Activity sheet, 'Describing life in the trenches', encourages students to describe the environment in the trenches, using adjectives and poetry to convey the conditions.

In the Activity sheet, 'A soldier's report', students take on the perspective of a soldier living in the trenches during World War I, reporting on the experience of World War I in their own words.

The Activity sheet, 'The role of nurses', explores the contribution of nurses through image analysis.

In the final Activity sheet, 'Technology in war', students gain an understanding of how advances of technology helped the soldiers in battle.

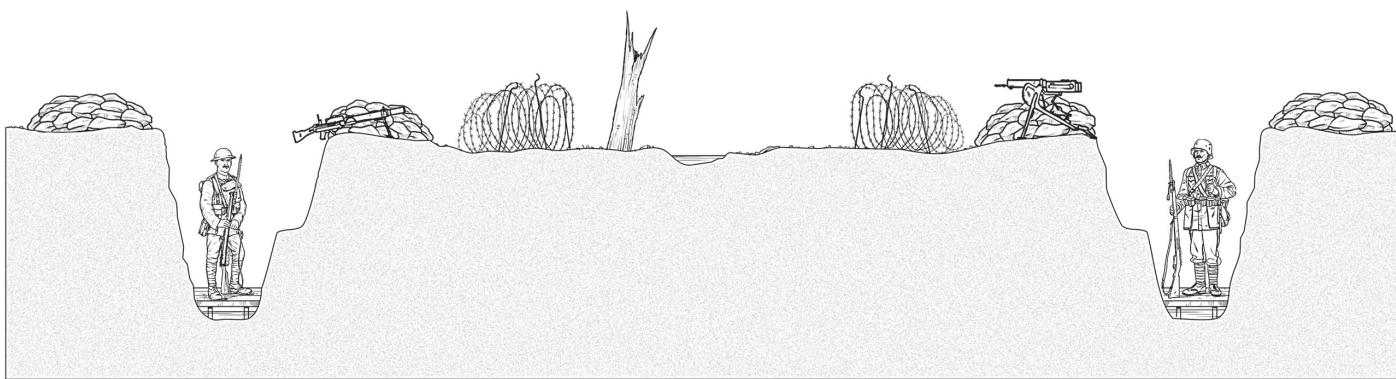
Extension ideas

- Students could explore the issue of the recognition of nurses during World War I and in subsequent conflicts. Possible questions to explore could be:
 - Why hasn't the contribution of nurses in World War I been recognised?
 - Was their contribution to World War I as important as that of the soldiers?
- Students could present their ideas in writing, giving reasons for their opinion, or they could participate in a class debate. Possible debate topics include:
 - Nurses should be recognised as soldiers
 - Soldiers are the most important people in a war
 - Women should not be involved in war
- Students could conduct research to find modern versions of the technologies shown on the final Activity sheet. Students could track the development of these military technologies to explore how they changed to meet the needs of soldiers in battle over different wars. Examples to research include tanks, poison gas and machine guns.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Life in the trenches

During World War I, **trench warfare** became the standard way for two sides to fight each other. A trench is a ditch or hole dug in the ground. Each side would hide in a trench to protect themselves from enemy gunfire and military shells. These trenches stretched all the way across the battlefield. The trenches of the Western Front spanned 764 km – this is almost the distance between Melbourne and Sydney (875 km).



The idea of trench warfare was for most of the group to make it across to the enemy's trench and take it over, gaining enemy territory. However, the invention of the machine gun meant that bullets could be fired very quickly. Soldiers faced certain death when they went 'over the top' of the trench.

The area between the trenches was known as 'no man's land'. This was the piece of land the soldiers had to cross in order to get to the enemy's trench. Many men died in 'no man's land', and stretcher bearers could not always reach these men to carry their bodies away.

If a soldier managed to avoid going 'over the top' they still had to survive living in the trenches. The underground bunkers the men lived in were freezing cold, and the rain at the Western Front caused a layer of mud, which soldiers had to stand in.

Disease was widespread. The damp, cold mud caused trench foot – an infection of the feet which caused them to swell. Many soldiers had their feet **amputated** (removed) because of this disease. The crowded, damp conditions also meant that lice and rats spread across the trenches, causing diseases such as trench fever, which was carried by lice.

Describing life in the trenches

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Life in the trenches', then answer the following questions.

Using adjectives

Adjectives are words we use to describe things.

- 1 Circle five adjectives on the Resource sheet, 'Life in the trenches', then list them in the table below. Some have been provided for you.
- 2 List another 12 adjectives of your own that could be used to describe the trenches.

freezing		
	damp	
		cramped

Using poetry

Poetry can help us understand how the soldiers felt while living in the trenches. One type of poem is a haiku. A haiku is made up of 3 lines. Each line has a set number of syllables.

HINT: A syllable is a beat in a word. For example, the word 'war' has one syllable. 'Trenches' has two, and 'Australia' has four.

-  3 Write a haiku about life in the trenches. Use the adjectives above to help you.

Line number	Number of syllables	Example	Your haiku
Line 1	5 syllables	Trenches are dirty	
Line 2	7 syllables	Crowded space of rats and lice	
Line 3	5 syllables	Wish you were not here	

A soldier's report

It is important to understand the point of view (perspective) of a soldier living in the trenches. Only then can we imagine what life in the trenches was really like.

-  1 Write a soldier's report about life in the trenches. Fill in the table below to help you plan your report.

Heading	Key words	Main point (one-sentence summary)	Details (evidence or examples)
Why trench warfare?		Trench warfare occurs when there is a stalemate .	• Soldiers dug trenches • Western Front trenches – 764 km long
Fighting from trenches	'over the top' no man's land gunfire		• •
Health hazards			• Trench foot often meant feet had to be amputated

- 2 Once you have completed your plan, write your report in full sentences.

Why trench warfare?

Fighting from trenches

Health hazards

The role of nurses

While men were fighting in the war, someone had to look after the sick and wounded. Female nurses and male medical orderlies cared for the injured men. We don't hear about the role of nurses very often but the war could not have been won without them.



This family photograph was taken in 1919, after World War I. It shows four siblings from the Malcolm family who all served in the war and all returned home safely to Victoria, Australia. Courtesy, Australian War Memorial P03166.001.

 1 Who is in the photograph?

2 Why do you think this family took the photo after the war? Why are they all still in war uniforms?

3 Who do you think are more important in this photograph: the soldiers or the nurses? Why?

Technology in war

In order to minimise casualties (dead and wounded), both sides used technology to support their soldiers. Technology means making, changing and using equipment in order to achieve goals. War technology uses this equipment to help soldiers win the war as quickly and effectively as possible. Tanks and machine guns are examples of how technology can be used in war to harm the enemy without risking soldiers on the frontline.

-  1
- The table below lists some of the kinds of technology that were used during World War I. Complete the table by filling in how each technology helped the soldiers. The first one has been done for you.

Technology	Used to ...	How it helped soldiers
Poison gas	Poison enemy soldiers	Poison gas is used to disable and confuse the enemy so that you can attack them.
Tanks	Get soldiers safely across dangerous territory	
Machine guns	Fire lots of bullets at enemy soldiers very quickly	
Shells	Explode, firing lots of bullets at the enemy soldiers	
Rifles	Fire single bullets to stop enemy soldiers	
Hand grenades	Cause quick explosions to harm enemy soldiers	
Battleships	Transport goods and soldiers across the sea	
Submarines	Fire at ships without being seen	
Wireless radio messaging system	Get messages and orders to the frontline quickly	

Objectives

- To use sources to understand the type of warfare during World War I
- To understand different perspectives

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

World War I was fought by everyday people who had to endure and survive terrible experiences. The primary sources they left behind, such as poems and letters home, help us to understand their experiences. By analysing these sources, we can learn more about the human experiences of World War I.

Starter activity

Begin by asking students how they would feel fighting on the frontline as a soldier. Encourage them to consider the following questions:

- How would they feel living in the trenches?
- How would they pass their free time?
- Would they miss their family and friends?
- How would they record their experiences?

Connect the idea of writing letters, journals and poetry to the modern equivalent of using social media to record experiences and reach out to friends and family.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'War poetry', introduces poetry as a form of expression for soldiers on the frontline in World War I. Students identify the meaning or synonym of key words in a selected poem in order to better understand the poem's main point.

In the Resource and Activity sheets, 'Journal entries (1) and (2)', students read an extract from the journal of an Australian soldier, then answer questions analysing the information and exploring how the soldier was feeling at the time.

The Activity sheet, 'Analysing sources', has students identify the perspective of writers of two different sources, giving evidence for each author's feelings. This allows students to document and compare the two perspectives.

In the final Activity sheet, 'Writing a letter home', students apply the vocabulary and emotions they have been exposed to in the unit and create their own letter home, written from the perspective of a soldier fighting in World War I. Sentence starters are provided to help students organise and communicate their ideas. Students will need a sheet of paper to plan and write their final letters.

Extension ideas

Students could write letters from different perspectives to compare the experiences of soldiers fighting in different conflicts, such as at Gallipoli and the Western Front.

War poetry

Soldiers who fought in World War I were forced to witness and carry out the killing of war. Many soldiers wrote poetry during the war to express and record their emotions.

 1 Read the following poem written by Wilfred Owen, a soldier in World War I.

Dulce et Decorum Est

by Wilfred Owen, October 1917

Bent double, like old beggars under sacks,
Knock-kneed, coughing like hags, we cursed through sludge,
Men marched asleep. Many had lost their boots
But limped on, blood-shod. All went lame; all blind;

If in some dreams you too could walk
Behind the wagon that we flung him in

My friend, you would not tell with such high zest
To children ardent for some desperate glory,
The old lie: *Dulce et decorum est*
Pro patria mori.

(Please note, this is an edited version of the original poem.)

About the author:

Wilfred Owen, 1893–1918
(killed aged 25)

- joined up under the pressure of propaganda in October 1915
- was blown up, concussed and suffered shell-shock (shock from shells constantly exploding)
- won the Military Cross in October 1918 for grabbing a German machine gun and using it to kill German enemy soldiers
- was shot and killed in France on 4 November 1918, a week before the war ended

2 Find the meaning of these words from the poem, then find a synonym for each word.

	Meaning	Synonym
beggars		
hags		
cursed		
sludge		
knock-kneed		
lame		
ardent		
glory		

Journal entries (1)

People write journal (diary) entries during wars to record their experiences. The journal entry below was written by an Australian soldier at Gallipoli.

Wednesday, 4 August 1915

The explosion of a bomb dropped by an enemy aeroplane woke me this morning just after dawn, it fell about 50 yards away and exploded with a deafening crash but did not damage. We have been engaged today constructing a sand bag shelter for a dressing station which is situated in our camp ... A large number of Kitchener's new army [a British army of volunteers, formed by Kitchener, the British Minister for War. They were fighting on the same side as Australia.] arrived here during the night ... Sixteen reinforcements [new soldiers sent to strengthen the army already fighting] arrived early this morning for our unit and one was wounded this afternoon while bringing water from the water depot. An enemy aeroplane passed over here at about 6pm and followed one of our own machines down towards the Cape, and a little later another of our planes circled overhead for a while.

Source: Australian War Memorial: PR00039 – Papers of Herbert Vincent Reynolds. <<http://www.awm.gov.au/blog/2010/08/04/wednesday-4th-august-1915-diary-of-hv-reynolds/>> 29 March 2013

Context:

- This journal entry was written by an Australian soldier, Private Herbert Vincent Reynolds, from Victoria.
- Reynolds enlisted on his 18th birthday, as soon as he could legally join the army, on 16 September 1914.
- The entry was written on 4 August 1915 in Gallipoli, where Reynolds had landed on 25 April.
- Reynolds was a stretcher bearer. He became ill and was evacuated on 16 August 1915.
- He served again during World War I in France and Belgium and was discharged from the army in 1919.

Journal entries (2)

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Journal entries (1)', then answer the following questions.

1 What happens in the journal entry?

2 What is your favourite line (sentence) in the journal entry?

3 How would the author feel about the arrival of reinforcements?

4 What was happening when the source was created?

5 Do you think the author is for or against the fighting of World War I? Why?

Analysing sources

It is important to look at who wrote the poem and journal shown on the previous pages, and the conditions and context they were written in. We can then compare the two sources and examine the authors’ feelings and their reasons for writing.

 Read the Activity sheet, ‘War poetry’, and the Resource sheet, ‘Journal entries (1)’, then answer the following questions about the source shown on each sheet.

Source 1: Poem	Source 2: Journal
1 What is being described in the source?	
2 Which line from the source best summarises what it is about?	
3 What was happening when the source was created?	
4 What does the source tell us about World War I?	
5 What does the source say about the daily life of soldiers in World War I?	
6 What happened to the author during their time fighting in World War I?	
7 Do you think the author felt differently about World War I once they had joined the fight? What makes you think this?	

Writing a letter home

 Imagine you are a soldier fighting on the Western Front or at Gallipoli in World War I. You are writing a letter to your mother in Australia.

Describe:

- 1 Why you joined the army
 - When did you join up?
 - Were many other people joining up with you?
- 2 What daily life is like for you in the army
 - What is it like to live and sleep with the sound of constant gunfire?
 - What are your living conditions like? (Is it clean? Is there disease?)
- 3 What you think and feel about the war
 - Do you think your side will win the war? Why?
 - Has your opinion about the war changed since you first joined up?

Paragraph 1: Greet your mother

- Dear Mum,
- I hope ... _____

Paragraph 2: Why you joined the army

- When I first joined up ... _____

Paragraph 3: What daily life is like for you in the army

- Every day I ... _____
- Living conditions are ... _____

Paragraph 4: What you think and feel about the war

- I think ... _____

Paragraph 5: Close (these could be the last words you ever say to your mother)

- Before I go ... _____

Love,

_____ (Your soldier name)

Objectives

- To understand the impact of war
- To describe the changing role of women and the conscription debate
- To use key terms and concepts
- To identify and respond to different kinds of questions

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

During the war a large proportion of the male population went to fight in World War I. The communities left behind had to function without these men and needed to keep up their morale despite constant reports of soldiers being killed. With men gone to the frontline, women were also given new work in order to support the war effort. In Australia, people who were from enemy countries were detained for the duration of the war to protect the home front.

Starter activity

Begin by introducing the concept of morale with students – explain that it involves feelings of confidence, optimism and self-esteem, and encourage students to make connections to their own experiences. Brainstorm situations when morale is needed and what forms this can take. Role-play these situations with students to help them understand the importance of morale, and how it can affect behaviour and outcomes.

Resource and Activity sheets

In the first Activity sheet, 'Keeping up morale', students explore the devices that were used to boost morale on the home front, such as songs and slogans.

The Activity sheet, 'News from the front', helps students to understand and empathise with the impact on the community when they received news of a death on the frontline.

In the Activity sheet, 'Enemies in Australia', students describe the experiences of people from other countries who were interned in Australia during World War I.

The Resource sheet, 'Women and the war effort (1)', describes the role of women in supporting the war effort, including fundraising and nursing.

In the final Activity sheet, 'Women and the war effort (2)', students check their comprehension of the Resource sheet by answering literal, inferential and evaluative questions, which increase in difficulty.

Extension ideas

- Students could create a poster promoting the importance of contributing to the war effort on the home front. This could employ strategies such as slogans or song lyrics to make the poster eye-catching. The poster could appeal to or directly address women in order to convince them to contribute to the war effort.
- Students could listen to recordings of songs from the era. Numerous original recordings can be found on the internet. For example: www.firstworldwar.com/audio/index.htm

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Keeping up morale

Many men left their homes to go and fight in World War I. As women, children and those who could not fight waited at home, it was vital that they remained positive about the war. We call this ‘keeping up morale’.

One way people kept their morale up was by singing songs that were positive about the war. Examples of these are shown below:

**‘Keep the Home Fires Burning
(Till the Boys Come Home)’**
Keep the home fires burning
While your hearts are yearning,
Though your lads are far away
They dream of home,
There’s a silver lining
Through the dark clouds shining,
Turn the dark clouds inside out,
Till the boys come home.

‘Pack Up Your Troubles’
Smile, boys, that’s the style.
What’s the use of worrying,
It never was worthwhile, so
Pack up your troubles in your old kit bag,
And smile, smile, smile.

Note: a kit bag was a bag used to hold the kit, or war equipment, that soldiers carried with them.

 Read the song lyrics above, then answer the following questions.

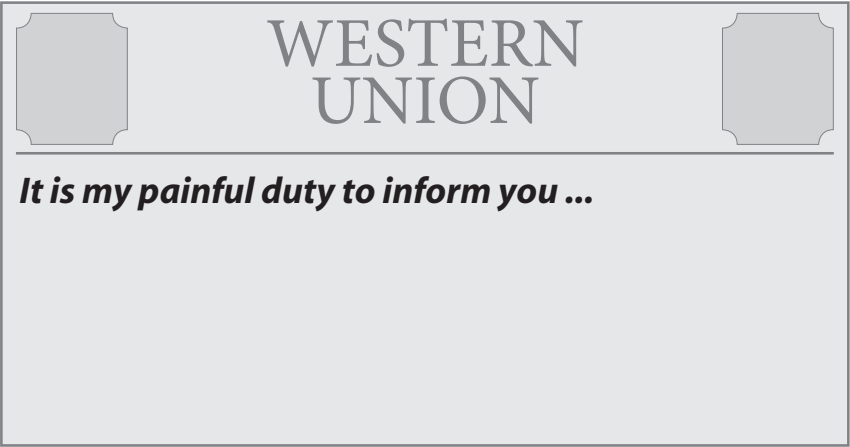
	‘Keep the Home Fires Burning (Till the Boys Come Home)’	‘Pack Up Your Troubles’
What message is the song sending to those at home?		
Why do you think the song was written?		
Who do you think it was written for?		
How would these lyrics make you feel during WWI?		

News from the front

When the people at home received news from the front, it was often informing them that their loved ones had been killed, wounded or were missing in action. Men often signed up with friends, so news from the front sometimes reported the deaths of several soldiers from one community.

Mothers, sisters, wives and friends would receive an official letter notifying (telling) them that their loved one had died. The letter would start:

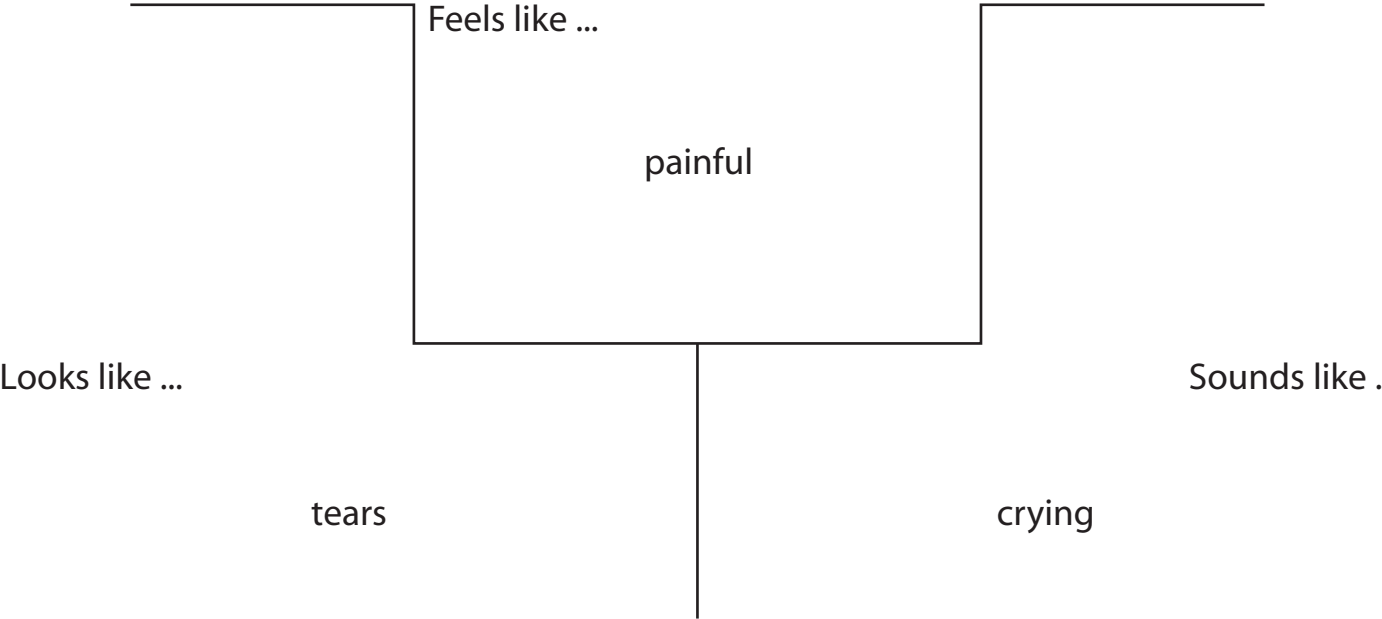
It is my painful duty to inform you ...



Not many letters start this way. When an army branded letter or **telegram** arrived, people knew that someone in their community had been wounded, killed or was missing, and might never return to them.

Imagine you are living in 1916 and you see a telegram being delivered to your neighbour. How might you react?

-  1 Complete the following diagram with words describing what the scene looks like, feels like and sounds like.



Enemies in Australia

When Australia joined the war on 4 August 1914, they were wary of the people living in Australia who came from enemy countries. Just one week after war was declared, all German citizens living in Australia were named ‘enemy aliens’. People from Turkey, Austria and Bulgaria were later given the same label. Enemy aliens were jailed until the war was over. People whose father or grandfather was from an enemy country were also jailed.

Internment camps were set up for the enemy aliens around Australia until 1915, when all the prisoners were moved to Holsworthy, New South Wales. The internment camp at Holsworthy held 4000–5000 prisoners. While the inmates were not free to leave, there were theatre and arts groups, cafes and education classes to prevent boredom.



- 1 What does the image show? _____
- 2 What are three emotions you would feel if you lived in an internment camp?

- 3 What were the living conditions like in the camps? _____
- 4 Would you want to live there? Why/why not? _____
- 5 Do you think this image shows the camps in a positive (good) or negative (bad) way? Why/why not? _____

Women and the war effort (1)

Before World War I broke out, a woman's role was considered to be in the home. Women were raised to be wives and mothers rather than to have a career or get an education. However, with their husbands, fathers and brothers gone to war, women had to manage the household finances, resources and family responsibilities alone. Many also had to deal with the grief of losing loved ones. Some women started working in the food, clothing and print industries.

Australian women actively contributed to the war effort in many ways. Some women raised money for charities such as the Red Cross, which sent home comforts like warm clothes to soldiers. Other women knitted socks and scarves for the soldiers.

Many women became nurses with the Australian army. The Australian Army Nursing Service (AANS) sent more than 2300 female nurses to places all around the world, including Egypt, France and Turkey. Seven Australian women earned the Military Medal (a bravery medal for people who weren't soldiers).

Some women wanted to help in other roles, such as drivers or cooks in the army, but the Australian army would not allow this.



c.1918. Courtesy, Australian War Memorial P05664.001.

Sister Rachael Pratt

1874–1954 (died aged 80)

- Sister Pratt was a nurse.
- She was born in Victoria.
- She enlisted in the war on 5 May 1915.
- She looked after wounded soldiers at Gallipoli and worked in Egypt and France as an army nurse.
- She was awarded the Military Medal for bravery under fire. In July 1917 a German bomb exploded, injuring Pratt. The shrapnel from the bomb cut into her back and punctured a lung. Despite her injuries, she kept caring for the soldiers until she collapsed.
- Sister Pratt returned to Australia at the end of the war but had chronic bronchitis (a lung infection).

Women and the war effort (2)

 Read the Resource sheet, 'Women and the war effort (1)', then answer the following questions.

Literal questions (the answer is HERE, written in front of you)

- 1 What was a woman’s role before World War I?
-
- 2 What are two ways Australian women contributed to the war effort?
-
-

Inferential questions (the answer is HIDDEN, you have to work it out based on the information provided)

- 3 Why wouldn’t the Australian army allow women to become drivers?
-
- 4 Why was World War I difficult for women?
-
- 5 Why would charities send home comforts to soldiers?
-

Evaluative questions (the answer is in your HEART, you have to give your opinion)

- 6 Why do you think the Australian army would not let women become drivers or cooks?
-
- 7 Do you think that Sister Rachel Pratt deserved the Military Medal? Why/why not?
-
- 8 Did the role of women change much as a result of World War I? Give two reasons for your answer.
-
-

Objectives

- To understand the type of warfare in World War I
- To identify the perspectives of people from the past
- To use key terms and concepts
- To use different communication forms

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

By 1917 World War I had been waged for nearly four years. Both sides of the conflict had suffered huge losses. Soldiers were tired of fighting a war that most people had assumed would be 'over by Christmas' back in 1914. Despite the success of the British naval blockade of Germany, the Triple Entente was starting to fall apart. The French suffered a mutiny and the Russians pulled out of the war after a revolution in Russia. It was the entry of America in April 1917 that sustained the Triple Entente and helped them force the Germans to surrender. The resulting armistice between leaders, which was signed in a railway carriage, came into force at 11 am on 11 November 1918.

Starter activity

Ask students how they would feel doing the same assignment for three years without a break, and without any evidence that they were doing well. Ask students to suggest emotions and list them on the whiteboard. Expand vocabulary by asking for associated words or synonyms, e.g. frustrated – tired – annoyed – upset.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'Three years at war', helps students understand the experiences and frustration of soldiers as they entered the fourth year of World War I.

The Activity sheet, 'The British naval blockade of Germany', explores the naval blockade from both British and German perspectives.

In the Activity sheet, 'The Triple Entente stumbles', students complete a cloze exercise describing what happened to the Triple Entente.

The Activity sheet, 'America joins in', explains how America's contribution helped the Triple Entente. Students complete a true/false activity to consolidate their understanding.

In the final Activity sheet, 'The end, the armistice', students explain the armistice from the perspective of an Australian soldier who is a veteran of the 1915 Gallipoli campaign.

Extension ideas

- Students could write a diary entry from the perspective of a German soldier who has spent three years on the Western Front, documenting their reaction to the armistice. Students could compare this to the Australian perspective explored on the Activity sheet, 'The end, the armistice', and analyse the similarities and differences.

Three years at war

By the start of 1917 the war had been going on for more than two years. When war broke out in July 1914 most people thought that it would be over by Christmas. But three Christmases later the war was still being fought, with no clear signs of victory for either side.

Soldiers were fighting on the frontline in **trenches** filled with damp, cold mud, living with disease, rats and lice. Explosions from shells (bombs) were constant. Soldiers who survived the shells had to face ‘going over the top’ and running into the path of enemy machine-gun fire as they tried to attack the enemy trenches.

-  1 The key words below summarise how soldiers felt in 1917. Find a synonym (similar meaning) and antonym (opposite meaning) of each key word.
- 2 Use the key word, synonym and antonym in a sentence about World War I.

Key word	Synonym	Antonym	Sentence
frustrated	annoyed	calm	By the start of 1917, soldiers felt frustrated and annoyed rather than calm about World War I.
tired			
disappointed			
depressed			
sick			
scared			
worried			

The British naval blockade of Germany

The British navy was the most powerful navy in the world. They used their ships to block German **ports** immediately after war broke out in August 1914. This stopped Germany getting new goods from other countries.

British naval ships would patrol the North Sea and stop **merchant ships** who were delivering goods to Germany. The Germans launched a **counter offensive**, using submarines to sink British ships, but the British were assisted by their allies, who protected British ships by travelling in large **convoys** so they could defend themselves.

The **blockade** worked. By 1915, German **imports** had fallen by 55% since the war began. This meant that Germans had to **ration** their food supplies, making everyday life very hard. This pressure reduced **nationalism** in Germany, making the German people less willing to keep fighting the war.

 Imagine you are a **British** mother in 1917. Complete the sentence starters to describe your feelings about the naval blockade. Use the key words provided.

- 1 This blockade is ... _____
- 2 I feel ... _____
- 3 I think that the British navy is ... _____
- 4 The Germans are ... _____

Key words:

necessary
war effort
deserve
guilty
revenge
weaken
enemy
punished

Now imagine you are a **German** mother in 1917. Complete the sentence starters to describe your feeling about the naval blockade. Use the key words provided.

- 5 This blockade is ... _____
- 6 I feel ... _____
- 7 I think that the British navy is ... _____
- 8 The Germans are ... _____

Key words:

cruel
depressing
innocent
family
civilians
rations
enemy
human

The Triple Entente stumbles

 1 Use the word bank to complete the following paragraphs.

The Triple Entente was an _____ between Great Britain, France and Russia and was formed before war was declared in July _____. It was big enough to take on the Triple Alliance of Germany, Austria-Hungary and _____. Although Italy did not eventually join the war, it was replaced in the Triple _____ by the Ottoman Empire (Turkey). This meant that the Triple Entente had to be _____ and united against their shared _____.

By 1917, _____ in the French armies were starting to show signs of _____ (anger). With heavy soldier losses, **mutiny** broke out in April, with soldiers refusing to follow _____.

In Russia the population and the army both _____ to fight for their ruler anymore and on 15 March 1917 the _____ (Russian King) was forced to step down. The new Russian leaders signed an _____ (peace agreement) with Germany.

The loss of the _____ in the Triple Entente meant that the Germans could now _____ their forces to the Western Front to face the _____ and French armies. The Triple Entente was _____ and needed support to stand up to Germany.

Word bank:

move

1914

Tsar

enemies

British

alliance

armistice

Alliance

Russians

refused

strong

Italy

unrest

weakened

orders

soldiers

2 Shade the area on the map where the Germans no longer had to fight after their armistice with Russia.



America joins in

America is far from Europe, and had no ties to the countries that were fighting. At the start of World War I, the USA declared that it was **neutral**, and did not send its soldiers into battle.

Americans disliked the Germans because of their submarine warfare. In February 1915 German submarines started attacking merchant ships and non-army ships. In May 1915 they sunk British-owned ship the *Lusitania*, an attack that killed thousands of passengers, including 128 Americans.

The Germans continued to sink ships belonging to neutral countries because they were trading with Britain. As a result, America declared war on Germany in April 1917. American troops arrived in France in June 1917. These fresh soldiers represented a significant positive change, and a turning of the tides for the Triple Entente. By the time the war ended, more than 2 million American soldiers had served on the Western Front, helping the Triple Entente win the war.

 1 Decide whether the following statements are true or false.

	True	False
Americans wanted to be involved in World War I in 1914.		
One million American soldiers served in World War I.		
The USA joined the war out of loyalty to Great Britain.		
The USA declared itself neutral at the beginning of World War I.		
Neutral means they will support one side over another.		
Germany used submarine warfare as a tactic in the war.		
No Americans were harmed when the <i>Lusitania</i> was sunk.		
The arrival of American troops in France marked a turning point in the war.		
America declared war on Germany in April 1917.		
The Triple Entente defeated Germany in World War I.		

The end, the armistice

Thanks to the Americans joining the fight in 1917, the Triple Entente grew stronger against the Triple Alliance. Germany was weakened by Britain’s continuing naval blockade. The German people were starving. They began holding strikes (stopping work) and anti-war marches to protest against the war. In September 1918 the German military leaders told the Kaiser (the German King) that the war was lost. The German navy **mutinied** in October and the Kaiser abdicated, or stepped down, on 9 November 1918.

An **armistice** (peace agreement) was signed between the leaders of all the fighting countries on 11 November. It was signed in a railway carriage in France and came into effect at 11 am on 11 November 1918.

 Imagine you are an Australian soldier at the Western Front who also fought at Gallipoli in 1915. You have just heard that the armistice has been signed. What do you feel? What are you looking forward to? Write a diary entry describing your thoughts.

Dear Diary,

Today I heard ... _____

I feel ... _____

I can't believe ... _____

I remember in Gallipoli ... _____

I can't wait to ... _____

Objectives

- To be able to describe the impact of World War I
- To understand different historical interpretations
- To understand different perspectives

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

The Treaty of Versailles was signed on 28 June 1919. The terms of the treaty were particularly harsh in response to the French and British desire to see Germany punished for its part in starting World War I. The treaty had 440 clauses, which stipulated that Germany would accept sole responsibility for starting the war, have part of its territory taken away, pay other countries back for the damage it caused and have its army reduced. This punishment was designed to ensure that Germany could never start a war again. Other Triple Alliance countries such as Austria, Hungary and Turkey also had parts of their territory taken away. This land was turned into new countries or given to countries on the winning side that helped make the treaty. The Treaty of Versailles resulted in both winners and losers, depending on which side countries were on during the war.

Starter activity 1

Encourage students to predict the terms of the treaty that would end World War I.

- Will the winners punish the losers?
- Will the treaty be a chance to punish the country that started the fight?
- Will the treaty be fair to both sides?

Starter activity 2

Familiarise students with the terms of the Treaty of Versailles with a running dictation activity. This activity is focused on group work, team-building skills and speaking and listening skills in low literacy students.

In your role as the teacher, concentrate on the:

- preparation (student analysis of text)
- dictation (do students speak slowly and clearly?)
- reconstruction (effective teamwork)

- 1 Introduce students to the terms of the Treaty of Versailles (see Activity sheet, 'Terms of the treaty'). Ensure that students understand the key concepts and vocabulary in the text.
- 2 Put students into groups and appoint a scribe for each group (this should be the most confident speller).
- 3 Display the terms of the treaty at the front of the room, or place numerous copies around the room.
- 4 Students must take it in turns to go up to the text and memorise as much of it as they can before returning to their group and dictating this to the scribe. When the scribe has finished writing, the next person can go.
- 5 When the entire text has been dictated, the groups sit together to edit their text for spelling, grammar and punctuation.
- 6 The groups are assessed on their accuracy and speed in completing the task.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'The Treaty of Versailles (1)', explains the purpose of the treaty that formally ended World War I for Germany.

In the Activity sheet, 'The Treaty of Versailles (2)', students unjumble key words from the Resource sheet, then use each one in a sentence to demonstrate their understanding.

The Activity sheet, 'Examining the treaty', helps students evaluate the treaty by asking literal, inferential and evaluative questions about its purpose.

The Activity sheet, 'Terms of the treaty', helps students assess the terms of the treaty from two differing perspectives.

In the Activity sheet, 'Mapping treatment under the treaty', students identify the territory gained, lost and created under the terms of the treaty.

Extension ideas

To further explore the different perspectives on the treaty, students could role-play an interview between representatives of different countries to help them understand different perspectives. Questions discussed could include:

- What was the purpose of the treaty?
- Do you think the treaty was fair?
- What do you think will be the long-term consequences of the treaty?

The Treaty of Versailles (1)

World War I officially ended at 11 am on 11 November 1918. However, the damage caused by a war that had dragged on for four years needed to be formally addressed by a **treaty** between the two sides.

What was the Treaty of Versailles?

A treaty is an agreement between two sides to stop fighting. There was a different treaty for each member of the Triple Alliance. The Treaty of Versailles dealt with Germany. The treaty was signed at the Palace of Versailles in France on 28 June 1919. It created formal peace between Germany and the members of the Triple Entente.

Who was involved?

Germany was the target of the treaty, but it was not part of the talks about what should go into it. Only the Triple Entente and their allies were present. Some of the allies, especially France, wanted to see Germany punished harshly for its part in the war.

Germany was presented with a finished treaty and forced to sign it because it had lost the war. Many people were angry with Germany, and the **terms** of the treaty were designed to punish Germany and make it weak so that it could not start another war.

What was the outcome?

The outcome was the harsh **punishment** of Germany. The terms of the treaty stated that Germany must accept **war guilt** by saying it was to blame for starting the war. There were **financial** (money), **military** (army) and **territory** (land) losses for Germany. It also had to pay **reparations** – money paid to other countries to make up for the damage caused. The treaty also created an organisation in Europe called the **League of Nations**, which would make decisions and help control nations like Germany.

The Treaty of Versailles (2)



Read the Resource sheet, 'The Treaty of Versailles (1)', then answer the following questions.

Unjumble the keywords from the Resource sheet, then use them in full sentences. The first letter of each jumbled word is underlined. The first one has been done for you.

1 yatter

a *treaty*

b A **treaty** is a formal peace agreement.

2 serpatarion

a

3 henpmistun

a _____

4 retms

a

5 awr gutil

a _____

6 nicanifal

a

7 tiliyarm

a _____

8 yortirret

a _____

9 fo queLea siNtaon

a

Examining the treaty

 Read the Resource sheet, 'The Treaty of Versailles (1)', then answer the following questions.

Literal questions (the answer is HERE, written in front of you)

- 1 What is a treaty?

- 2 Who was involved in the treaty talks?

- 3 What three things did Germany lose as a result of the treaty?

Inferential questions (the answer is HIDDEN, you have to work it out based on the information provided)

- 4 From a Triple Entente perspective, why was the treaty needed?

- 5 Would Australia be involved in the treaty talks? Why/why not?

- 6 Why did France want Germany to be harshly punished by the treaty?

Evaluative questions (the answer is in your HEART, you have to give your opinion)

- 7 Do you think France was a neutral place to have treaty talks? Why/why not?

- 8 Do you think the treaty was fair on Germany? Why/why not?

- 9 If you were German, how would you feel about the outcome of the treaty? Why?

Terms of the treaty

The Treaty of Versailles included clauses (terms) that Germany had to agree to in order to make peace with other countries. This included five clauses:

- 1 A League of Nations was created. This was a group of nations who would work together to stop wars happening.
- 2 ‘War guilt’ meant Germany had to accept responsibility for starting World War I.
- 3 Germany had to pay money to other countries to make up for the damage caused during the war.
- 4 Military removal meant that Germany’s army and navy were restricted, and it was not allowed to have an air force.
- 5 Land removal meant that much of Germany’s territory was given away to other countries.

 Answer the following questions about the clauses in the treaty from the perspectives of Germany and France.

Germany	France
1 Do you think that the new League of Nations will treat you fairly? Why/why not?	
2 Do you think Germany should have to accept all the blame for the war? Why/why not?	
3 Is it fair that Germany is the only member of the Triple Alliance that has to pay damages to other countries? Why/why not?	
4 Should Germany be allowed to keep its large military? Why/why not?	
5 Should some of Germany’s land be taken away from it? Why/why not?	

Mapping treatment under the treaty

The loss and gain of land during World War I led to changes in Europe’s borders. Countries in the Triple Alliance had parts of their territory taken away. This land was given to members of the Triple Entente or turned into new countries. This meant that Europe looked very different after the war.

-  1 Study the maps showing the changes in Europe’s borders, then fill in the country names in the table below.

Europe, 1914 (pre-World War I)



Countries that have gained land
Countries that have lost land
Newly created countries

Europe, 1919 (post-World War I)



Objectives

- To be able to explain the type of warfare during World War I
- To understand different perspectives
- To use information from sources as evidence in argument

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

World War I had consequences for all of society. The loss of men during the war had repercussions for families, communities and nations. The Germans saw the Treaty of Versailles as unfair, and the harsh punishment Germany had received sowed the seeds for revenge and the commencement of World War II. The weakening of Europe throughout the war also enabled America to dominate global politics as the new world power.

Starter activity

Encourage students to consider how society could return to normal after World War I. Brainstorm issues that might arise in a society after a war has just ended, such as food shortages, unemployed men and injured or disabled returning soldiers. Have students suggest ways in which these challenges to society could be resolved.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity sheet, 'The loss of men', helps students to understand how the loss of men in the war affected families, communities and Australia as a whole.

The Activity sheet, 'A harsh punishment', helps students understand Germany's perspective on the punishment they received, and how this motivated them to seek revenge during World War II.

The Resource sheet, 'America becomes the new world power', examines how World War I shifted the balance of power throughout the world, leaving European countries weakened and having to rebuild, while America enjoyed a time of great prosperity.

In the Activity sheet, 'How did America become the new world power?', students form an argument outlining how America gained new power by presenting a main idea, providing evidence and examples, and linking these back to the topic of the treaty and World War I.

In the Activity sheet, 'The good times in America', students examine two source images and extract information about America in the 1920s and its policy of self-preservation.

Extension ideas

Students could track America's rise to power, from its early beginnings to global dominance. Research questions could include:

- Who founded America?
- What made America richer after the war?
- What technologies did America create after World War I?
- What was it like to live in America after the war?
- Why did Europe take a long time to recover from World War I?

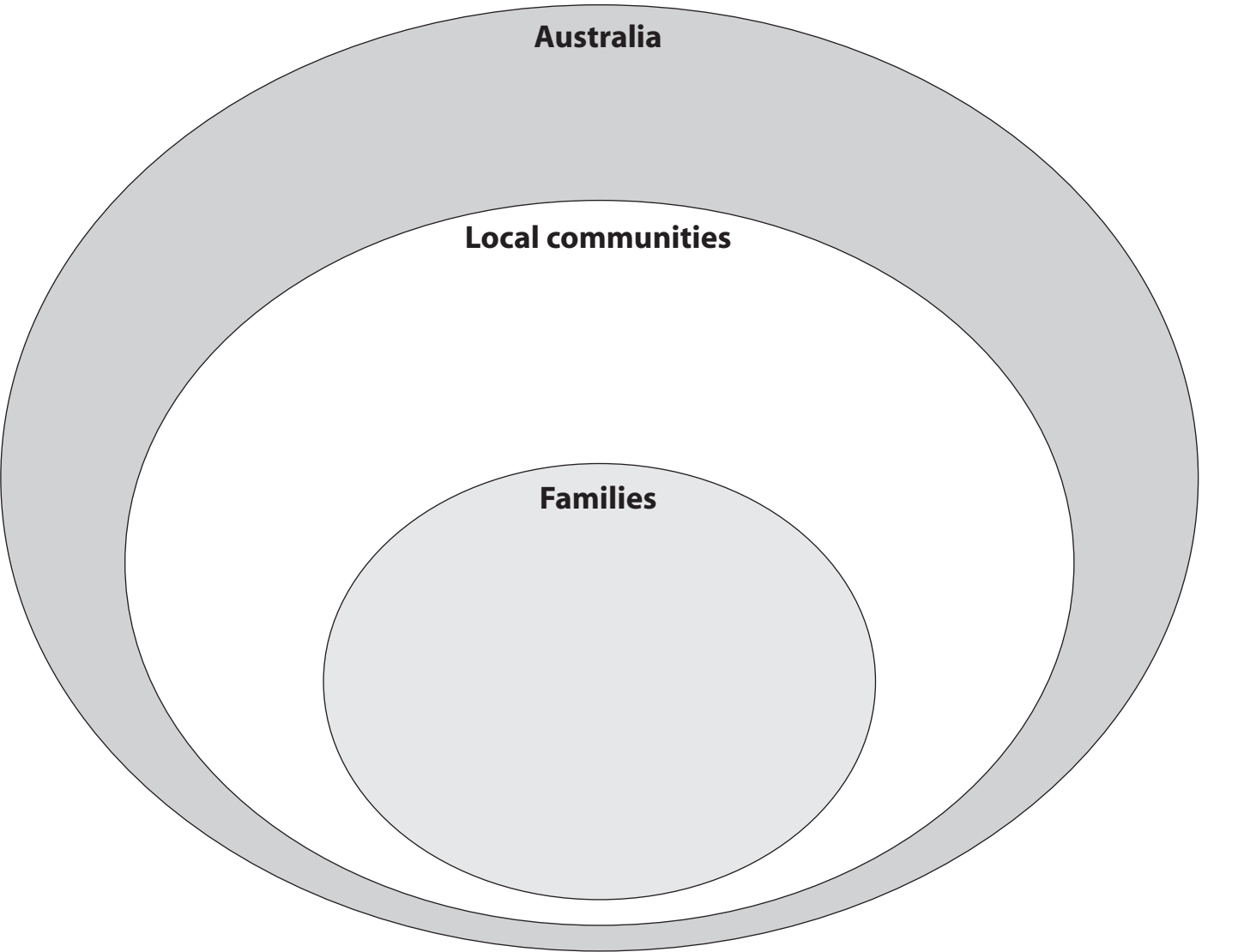
The loss of men

World War I was declared over at 11 am on 11 November 1918. Countless lives had been lost. In Australia, of the 416 809 men who enlisted, more than 60 000 were killed and 156 000 were wounded or taken prisoner. The population of Australia at the time was less than 5 million, so this was a significant proportion of fathers, husbands, workers and friends who would never be coming home.

The loss of men in Australia affected:

- families
- local communities
- the nation as a whole.

 In the circles below, list ways that the loss of men would have affected or changed life for each group of people.



A harsh punishment

Imagine your friend gets into a fight at lunchtime. You rush to help support them. More people join in, and eventually you lose the fight. The winner is allowed to pick your punishment, and they make you:

- accept the blame for starting the fight in the first place
- pay money for damages to others
- give up some of your possessions.

 1 How does this make you feel? _____

2 Is this a fair punishment? Why/why not? _____

3 Would you try to get revenge? Why/why not? _____

This was how Germany felt after World War I. They had lost the war and could not fight back against the victorious Triple Entente, so they had to sign the treaty.

Germany was humiliated (embarrassed). It was forced to accept all the blame for a war that had been building up for a long time. The money Germany had to pay for damage caused by the war took money away from the German war recovery.

Many Germans were angry about this treatment. They wanted revenge on other countries and were eager to prove that Germany could be strong again. These feelings led to the outbreak of a longer and more widespread war in 1939 – World War II.

4 Could Germany have just refused to sign the treaty? Why/why not? _____

5 Why did World War II occur? _____

America becomes the new world power

Most countries in Europe were left weakened by World War I. For years their lives had been focused on a war that was suddenly over. Communities had to rebuild after significant losses of men and resources.

Empires such as the British Empire had been called world powers because they controlled much of the world. However, the losses they had sustained meant that many countries were no longer as powerful. Some empires, such as the German and Ottoman empires, were broken up entirely. This loss of territory meant they were no longer empires, and were simply called Germany and Turkey.

One country, however, became more powerful after the war. This was America, who didn't join the war until 1917.

Despite joining the war late, the Americans lost thousands of men in the conflict. US President Wilson, who had made the decision to join the war, was defeated in the 1920 election by Warren Harding. Harding believed that America should protect itself and not worry about outside events. He wanted America to stay out of the League of Nations, to limit immigration (people from other countries coming to live in America) and to give businesses more freedom. The American government had been controlling businesses during World War I in many ways, such as telling them what to produce (make).

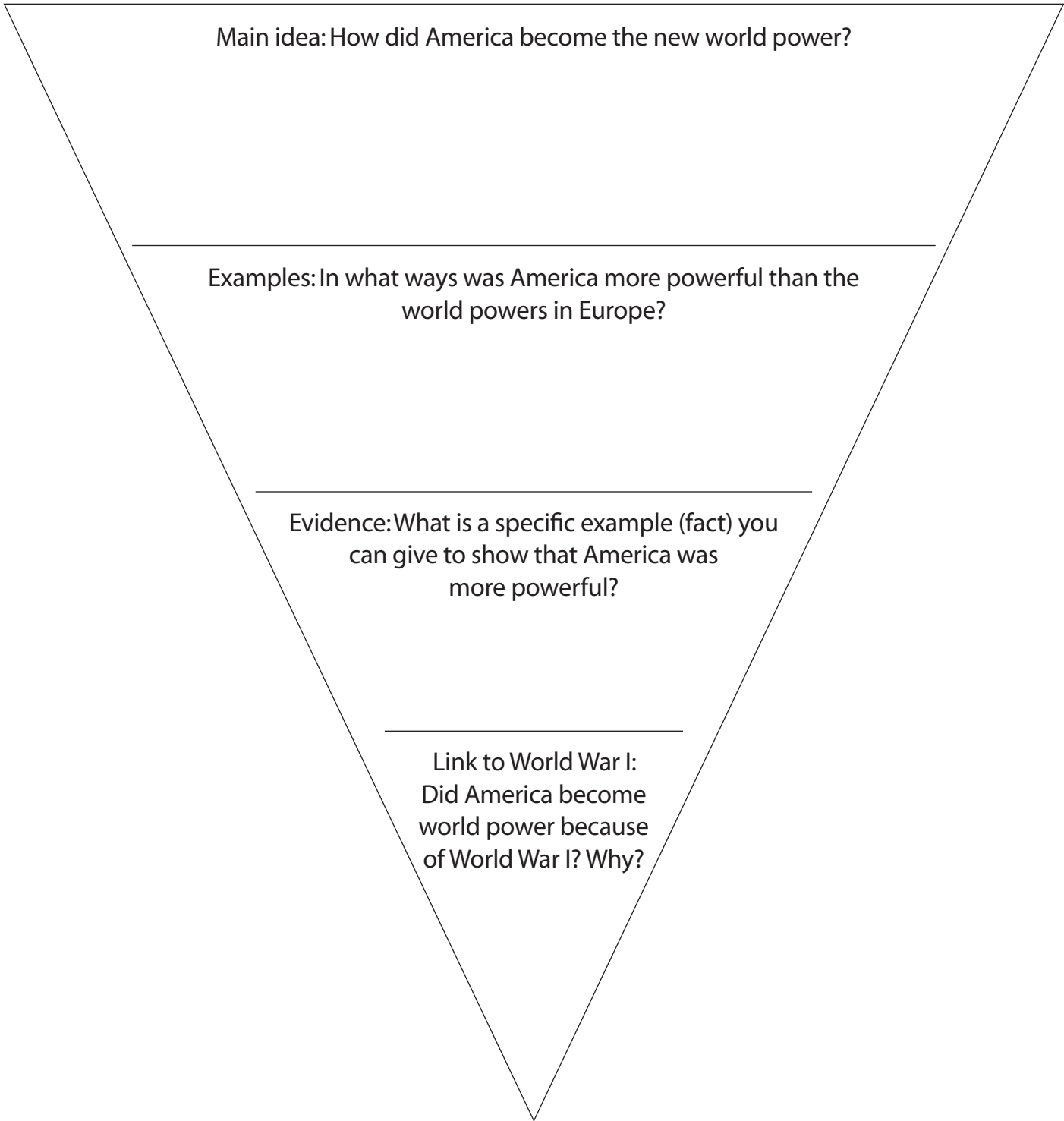
President Harding's election showed that most Americans wanted to make America stronger, rather than helping others in Europe. At the start of the 1920s, **wages** in America were higher than in Europe because their resources had not been dedicated to four years of war. People used this extra money to improve their lives by buying cars and new consumer appliances.



How did America become the new world power?

 Read the Resource sheet, ‘America becomes the new world power’, then use the information to complete the argument triangle below.

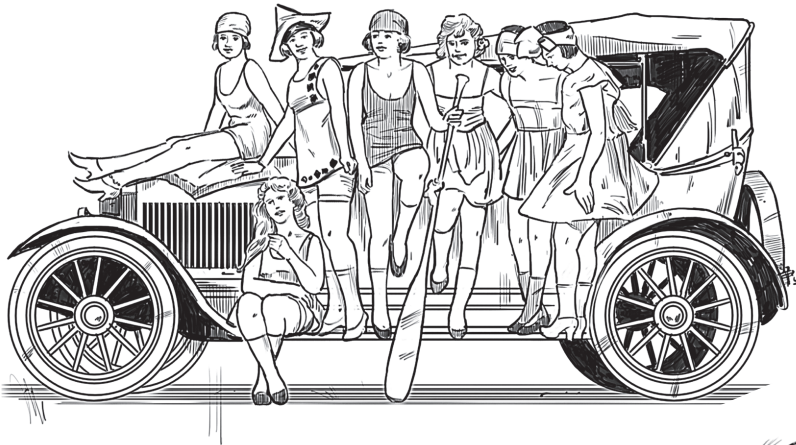
How did America become the new world power?



The good times in America

In the 1920s, America was the wealthiest country in the world. Americans were paid higher wages, which meant they could buy more things. It also meant they didn't have to work as many hours, so they had more leisure time. This in turn created jobs for sellers and entertainers. There was a boom in the car industry, and people enjoyed more entertainment, such as jazz music.

The pictures below show what life in America was like in the 1920s.



Source 1



Source 2

 Answer the questions below about the pictures.

1 What is shown in the picture?

Source 1: _____

Source 2: _____

2 What does the picture tell you about America in the 1920s?

Source 1: _____

Source 2: _____

Objectives

- To describe the impact of World War I
- To ask questions that help us to understand the past
- To evaluate sources

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

Soldiers returning home from World War I had to adapt to the civilian life that they had left behind. Many were haunted by the mental and physical scars of war and found it hard to return to their old lives. While some support, such as the Soldier Settlement Scheme, was given to returning soldiers to help them find new roles, most soldiers found it difficult to adjust after witnessing the horrors of war.

Starter activity

Conduct a 'think, pair, share' activity regarding the concept of returning home. Questions to prompt thinking could include:

- What does 'returning home' mean?
- Could a soldier ever forget seeing his friends die on the battlefield?
- How might they feel about having killed someone?
- Do you think a soldier could return to their old life? Why/why not?

Encourage students to make connections between World War I soldiers and those returning from current conflicts.

Resource and Activity sheets

The first Activity Sheet, 'Returning home', helps students understand the transition of soldiers from World War I to their civilian lives.

In the Activity sheet, 'Senses in war', students describe the experiences soldiers went through by exploring how each of the five senses were affected during the war and at home.

The Resource sheet, 'The roles of World War I veterans (1)', presents images of returning soldiers in their new civilian roles, offering students an insight into the lives they were adapting to.

In the Activity sheet, 'The roles of World War I veterans (2)', students analyse the pictures from the Resource sheet in order to gain a better understanding of the returning soldiers' experiences.

In the final Activity sheet, 'Interview with a World War I veteran', students design an interview with a World War I veteran, listing questions to ask and enhancing these with a mix of literal, inferential and evaluative questions.

Extension ideas

- Students could role-play their interview from the Activity sheet, 'Interview with a World War I veteran', with a partner.
- Students could interview a veteran from a more recent conflict and link their experiences of returning home to those of World War I veterans.

Returning home

 Use the words in the word bank to complete the following paragraphs.

The ending of the war at 11 am on 11 November 1918 meant that Australian soldiers could finally _____ home. Many _____ men had been keen to join the war. Of the 416 809 men who _____, more than 60 000 died in battle. Many _____ soldiers found it difficult to fit back into their normal lives after their _____ experiences.

Some soldiers were scarred, both mentally and _____. They had witnessed people being killed, including their _____; they had also killed _____ themselves. They had lived in trenches and been exposed to constant _____ bombings and machine-gun fire. Many now had to deal with long-term injuries, such as _____ from gas attacks or _____ limbs.

The Australian _____ tried to help the returning soldiers. They set up the Soldier Settlement Scheme, which gave returning soldiers small pieces of _____ land so they could take on new roles and become _____. Thousands of soldiers became farmers, but not all made the _____ successfully.

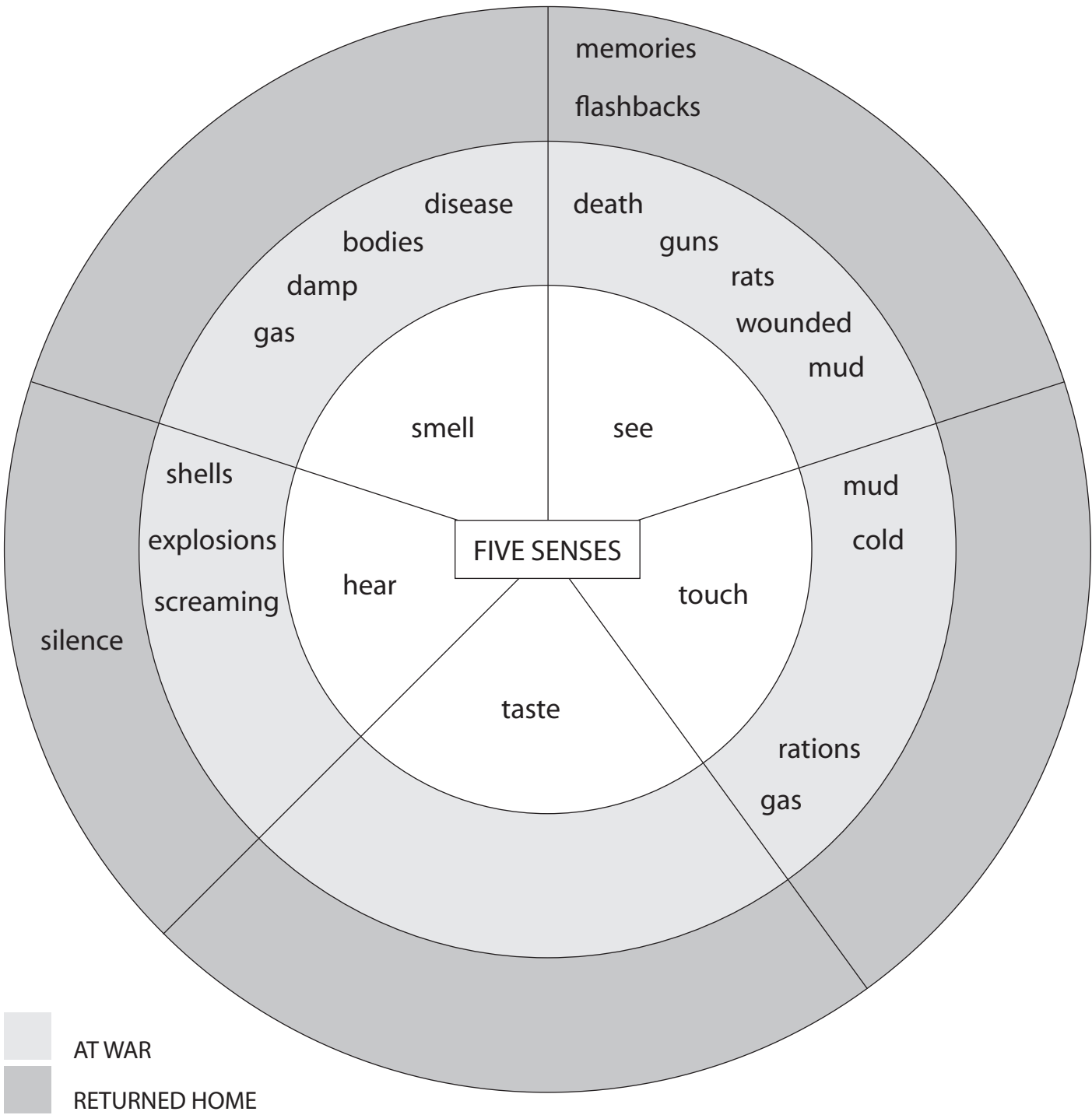
The _____ or Returned Sailors and Soldiers Imperial League of Australia (which today is called the Returned & _____ League of Australia) was created in _____ to speak about the problems being faced by returned soldiers. This organisation still exists _____ to help soldiers when they return to _____ life.

Word bank:
wartime
civilian
change
RSL
Australian
1916
farm
blindness
physically
today
returning
Services
amputated
friends
Government
enlisted
return
people
shell
farmers

Senses in war

Most people have five senses. These shape what we see, hear, smell, touch and taste during our lives. Soldiers in World War I experienced the war using all five senses.

-  Read the senses circle, then fill in:
- the blank space on the 'At war' circle.
 - the spaces on the 'Returned home' circle, listing what soldiers were sensing when they returned home.



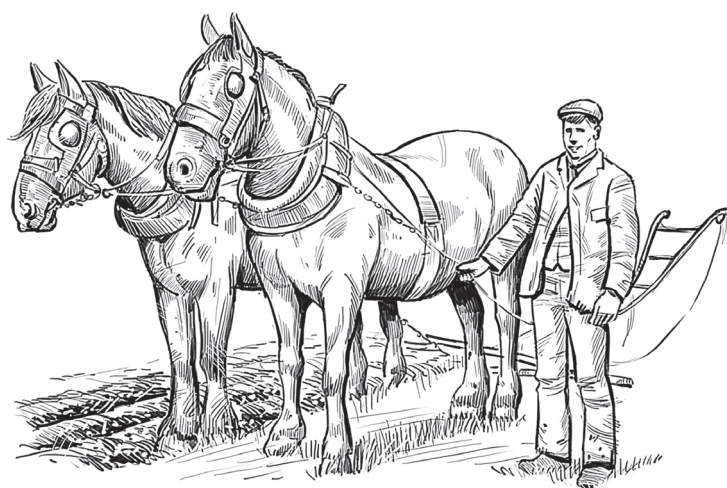
The roles of World War I veterans (1)

The returning soldiers were called **veterans**. After the war, the veterans had to fit back into everyday life. Some had to learn new skills and try new jobs. The following pictures record the experiences of World War I veterans living and adapting to civilian life.

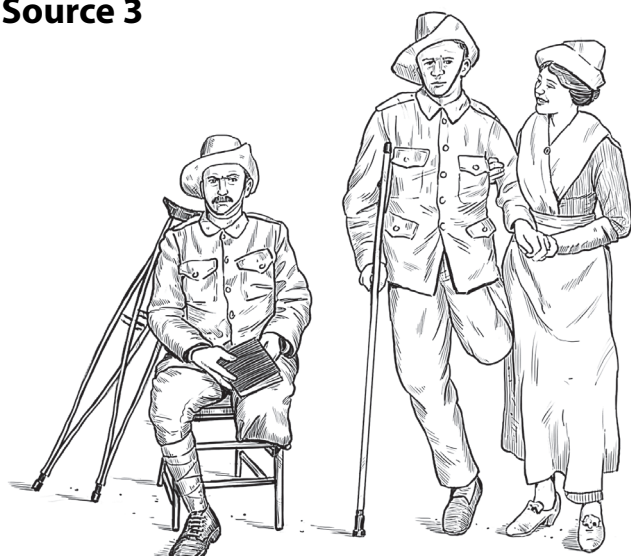
Source 1



Source 2



Source 3



The roles of World War I veterans (2)

They say a picture paints a thousand words. In order to gain these words we need to ask questions and find information in a picture in order to understand what it is showing us.

 Read the Resource sheet, 'The roles of World War I veterans (1)', then answer the following questions about the three picture sources.

	Source 1	Source 2	Source 3
What is shown in the picture?			
Who would have witnessed this scene?			
Why was this picture drawn? What is its purpose?			
What does the picture tell you about the returned soldiers?			
What is the role (job) of the returned soldiers in the picture?			
What is one question you have about the picture?			

Interview with a World War I veteran

We ask questions to find out more about a topic, person or event. In order to learn more about World War I and the experiences of returned soldiers, you will interview a veteran of World War I.

 Write questions you will ask the veteran in the space below.

To make the interview interesting, ask a mix of literal, inferential and evaluative questions.



1 Literal questions

Example: What is your name?

What was your position in the army?

2 Inferential questions

Example: Why did you join the war?

How did you feel living in the trenches?

3 Evaluative questions

Example: Do you still feel that going to war was the right thing to do?

Do you think that the Australian Government did enough to help the veterans returning from war?

Objectives

- To describe the commemoration of World War 1
- To understand the significance of the Anzac legend
- To use information from a range of sources
- To use different forms of communication

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge to complete these activities.

Background

Across the world people commemorate the end of World War I on 11 November each year. Known as Remembrance Day, this marks the date that World War I ended. People observe one minute of silence at 11 am on this date. Remembrance Day also commemorates those who suffered or died in subsequent wars. In the week before Remembrance Day people wear red poppies because these were the flowers that grew on the battlefields where the soldiers gave their lives. Wearing a poppy shows that we remember them.

Australians observe Anzac Day on 25 April each year to remember the contribution of the Australian and New Zealand (Anzac) army. This was the day the Anzacs landed at Gallipoli and proved themselves in battle. On this day Australians remember the 8000 Australian soldiers who were killed at Gallipoli and celebrate the Anzac legend.

Starter activity

Play students a sample of 'The Last Post', which is played on Anzac Day during dawn services.

- Ask students how the music made them feel. Help them to recognise and articulate the emotions they experienced.
- Ask students to identify whether they have heard the music before, and where.
- If students have not heard the music before, ask them to predict why it was written and what it would be used for in connection to World War I.
- Explain the place of 'The Last Post' in Anzac Day dawn service ceremonies – after The Ode and before 'Lest we forget' is spoken.

- 'The Last Post' can be downloaded at:
www.awm.gov.au/commemoration/customs/last_post.asp

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'How we remember (1)', introduces scenes of remembrance for World War I soldiers, showing images of Remembrance Day and Anzac Day services.

The Activity sheet, 'How we remember (2)', asks students to analyse the images on the Resource sheet. This information will also be used to strengthen the students' arguments in their work on the Activity sheet, 'Is remembering World War I important?'

In the Resource sheet, 'The significance of the Anzac legend (1)', students explore differing perspectives regarding whether or not Anzac Day is important to Australians.

The Activity sheet, 'The significance of the Anzac legend (2)', encourages students to form their own opinion about the Anzac legend, prompting them to question both sides of the debate presented on the Resource sheet.

In the final Activity sheet, 'Is remembering World War I important?', students consider the importance of remembering World War I and provide evidence for their opinion, referring to the Resource sheet, 'How we remember (1)'. Students should refer to their analysis on the Activity sheet, 'How we remember (2)', to support their argument.

Extension ideas

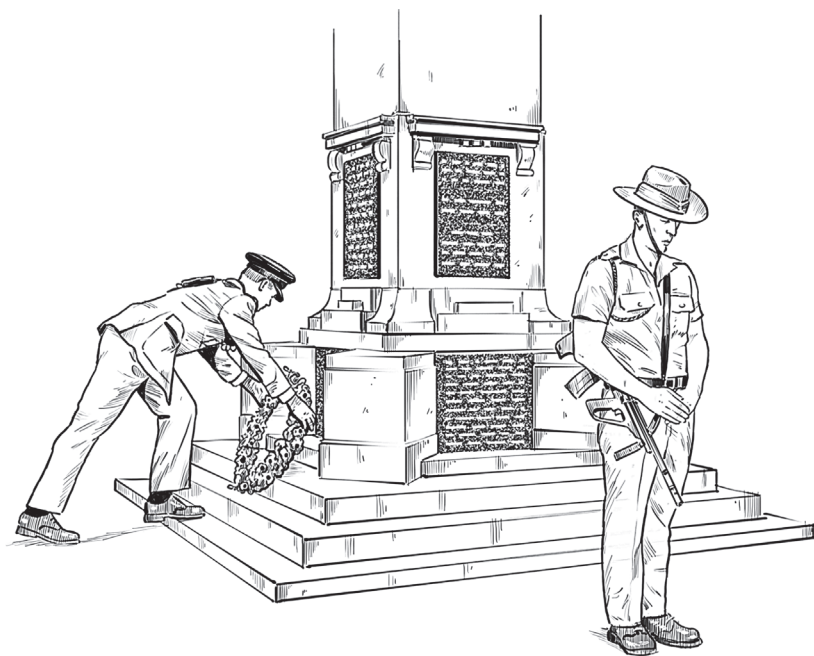
- Students could adapt their argument from the Activity sheet, 'Is remembering World War I important?', into an oral presentation.
- Students could use ICT to create a brochure, poster or blog to promote Anzac Day. Information could be sourced from the local RSL, museums and online.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

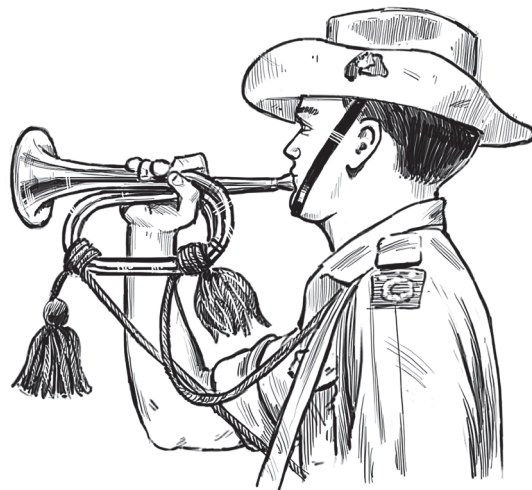
How we remember (1)

Remembrance Day is held to mark the end of World War I on 11 November each year. At 11 am on Remembrance Day we hold one minute of silence to remember the soldiers who fought for their country. Australians also recognise Anzac Day on 25 April each year. The day begins with a dawn service to remember the Australian and New Zealand (Anzac) army contributions.

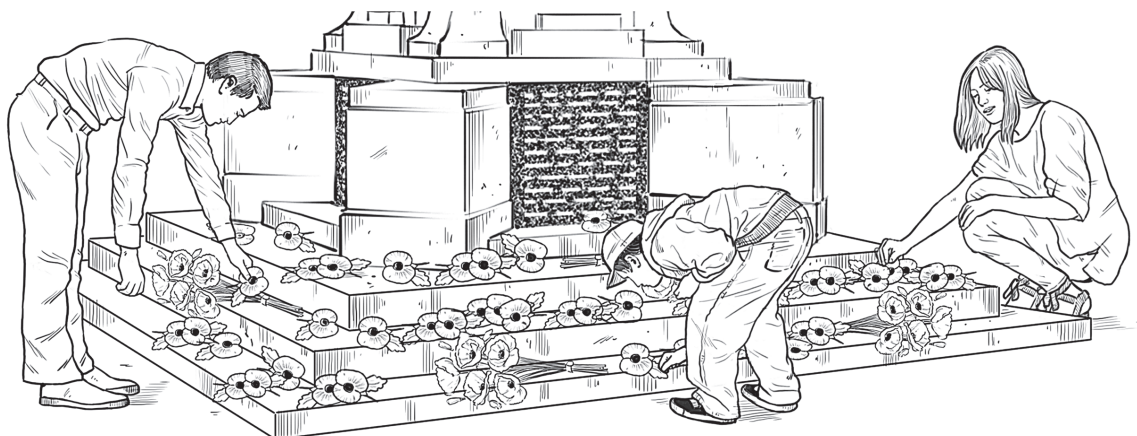
Source 1



Source 2



Source 3



How we remember (2)

In order to understand what a picture says about World War I, we need to ask questions about what we see. Pictures are important sources of information about World War I.

 Read the Resource sheet, ‘How we remember (1)’, then describe the images on the Resource sheet in the table below.

	Source 1	Source 2	Source 3
1 What is the picture showing?			
2 List adjectives that describe the people in the picture (e.g. young, silent).			
3 Suggest verbs to describe what the people in the picture are doing (e.g. bowing, remembering).			

4 Use the words you have listed in the table to describe each source in full sentences.

Source 1:

Source 2:

Source 3:

The significance of the Anzac legend (1)

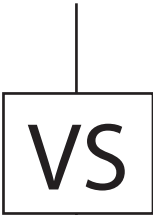
Many Australians participate in Anzac Day by attending dawn services or marches to remember the veterans of World War I. However, not everyone believes that this is important. The text below presents both sides of this debate.

YES – Remembering the Anzacs is important

Statement: I believe that remembering the Anzacs is important.

- We should not forget the sacrifices that were made for Australia in World War I and that continue to be made by soldiers today.
- The recognition of the Anzac spirit celebrates what is great about Australians and what we think is important, such as hard work and looking after your mates.
- It is important that we don't forget the horrors of war, to ensure that a war like World War I does not happen again.

Closing statement: In conclusion, I believe that remembering the Anzacs is important.



NO – Remembering the Anzacs is not important

Statement: I believe that remembering the Anzacs is not important.

- Anzac Day celebrates killing people and death – soldiers killed people, which is something we shouldn't celebrate or glorify.
- New Australians cannot relate to Anzac Day and celebrating it makes them feel isolated.
- To a lot of Australians, Anzac Day is no longer relevant, and is just an excuse for a public holiday.

Closing statement: If you agree that we shouldn't celebrate killers then you'll agree that remembering the Anzacs is not important.

The significance of the Anzac legend (2)

The Resource sheet, ‘The significance of the Anzac legend (1)’, presents two different perspectives (opinions) about remembering the Anzacs. When studying history it is important to question what you read. Only then can you understand the information and form your own opinion.

 Read the Resource sheet, ‘The significance of the Anzac legend (1)’, then answer the following questions.

	YES – Remembering the Anzacs is important	NO – Remembering the Anzacs is not important
What are the three reasons given for the opinion?	1. 2. 3.	1. 2. 3.
Which do you think is the most convincing reason given for each opinion? Why?		
Which do you think is the least convincing reason given for each opinion? Why?		
Do you agree with this opinion? Why/why not?		
Write a sentence stating your opinion about the importance of remembering the Anzacs.		

Is remembering World War I important?

When forming an opinion on history, it is important to provide evidence to support your point of view. Decide whether you think remembering World War I is important, then complete the table below, giving reasons and evidence for your opinion.

 Refer to the Resource and Activity sheets, 'How we remember (1) and (2)', for evidence to support your opinion.

Question: Is remembering World War I important?

Statement of opinion e.g. 'I think that ...'		
	Reason	Evidence
Example	We should remember the sacrifices the soldiers made for Australia.	Source 1 shows someone laying a wreath of poppies to show that it is important to remember the soldiers who fought in WWI.
Reason 1		
Reason 2		
Reason 3		
Conclusion: e.g. 'In conclusion, I believe ...'		

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This title looks at Australia’s role at Gallipoli and the Western Front, the nature of warfare, strategies for maintaining morale, the role of nurses and the role of America in ending World War I. The consequences of the war are also studied, such as casualties, how returning soldiers adjusted to civilian life, the Treaty of Versailles and the emergence of America as a new world power. Historical and literacy skills are developed through interpreting photographs, journals, poetry and songs from the era. Students develop skills in generating historical questions and communicating in different forms.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These files can be easily edited to suit the needs of students.

Topics include

- | | |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| Gallipoli | Turning the tides |
| Anzacs on the Western Front | Peace at last |
| Fighting on the frontline | Consequences of the Treaty |
| Recording war experiences | From soldier to civilian |
| Keep the home fires burning | We will remember them |

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